# Project 8: the Babylonian fables and contests (eBL L/2/8, 9, 11, 12, 13)

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Round 5, run 5 (2026-10-31). Keys **PV** (Palm and Vine), **PO** (the Poplar), **OH** (Ox and Horse), **SP** (the
Spider), **WR** (the Wren); files `annotated-<KEY>.rtl.md`, intros `translation--intro-<KEY>.rtl.md`, head `translation--head.rtl.md`; built by `../wisdom_tools.py build`. Renderings: `../renderings.md` (§12 for this run);
brief `../translator-brief--round5-run5.md`.

## Scope and base

All five eBL chapters, 454 labels: Palm and Vine (`L/2/12`, 54; ed. and tr. Jiménez), the Series of the Poplar (`L/2/8`,
82), the Series of Ox and Horse (`L/2/9`, 217), the Series of the Spider (`L/2/11`, 59), the Story of the Poor, Forlorn
Wren (`L/2/13`, 42) – `../../sources/eBL/Fable-*/`, fetched 2026-10-31, no empty **N:** lines. Rank 3: eBL's English

(Jiménez). Not available: Jiménez 2017 (*The Babylonian Disputation Poems*, the print edition: a purchase; records only),
Lambert 1960 (*BWL*).

## Why

Judg 9:8–15 (the trees and their king), 2 Kgs 14:9, Ezek 17 (the plant and eagle fables); the Wren and the Eagle
against Etana; the disputation genre (Sumerian contests in the creation corpus).

## Order

PV, PO (Judg 9 first), OH, SP, WR.

## Progress

- 2026-10-31: set up by the coordinator (keys in `wisdom_config.py`, renderings §12).

## PV

### Scope

Palm and Vine (eBL `L/2/12`, ed. and tr. E. Jiménez), all 54 labels (1'–54'): the end of Palm's speech (1'–28'), the
transition (29'–30'), Vine's (Wine's) answer (31'–54'); the beginning and the end (Palm's second speech, any verdict) are
lost. Manuscripts: three Hellenistic library tablets from Uruk (UrkHel1, the main witness for 4'–54'; UrkHel2, the only
witness for 1'–3'; UrkHel3) and a Late Babylonian school tablet (BabaLBSch1). File `annotated-PV.rtl.md`; intro
`translation--intro-PV.rtl.md`; generated `translation-PV.rtl.md`.

### Sources consulted

eBL reading edition, ATF, glossary (`../../sources/eBL/Fable-Palm-and-Vine/`); Jiménez's English (rank 3, read after the
draft of each line). The corpus renderings (§1–§12), the Theodicy (Th1 1, 32, 55, 56), the Šamaš Hymn, the Dialogue of
Pessimism, the Poor Man, Gilgameš, and the cross-corpus survey (`tools/harmonize_survey.py`) for every new word.
Not available: Jiménez 2017 (the print edition, with its commentary).

## Decisions

- **The contestants as names, without the article** (the Sumerian contests' rule, creation corpus §9.1): *arhānû* = דְּקָל (a lexical-list word; תָּמָר stays *gišimmaru*'s: Theodicy 56, PO d+17); *karānu* = יַיִן (every corpus
  has *karānu* = יין: Ludlul V 58, Gilgameš XI 73, EST, Maqlû; the speaker presents himself as a drink, 33', 36'; both
  manuscripts write {giš}GEŠTIN, the plant – noted at 29'). Rejected: גֶּפֶן (it would split *karānu* across the corpora
  and blur Judg 9:12–13's own split תִּירוֹשׁ / גֶּפֶן). The modern title "הדקל והגפן" (wisdom_config) is Jiménez's
  and stays the work's name; the intro's title is הדקל והיין.
- **Formulas** (fixed here, for OH/SP/WR): self-presentation *anākū-ma X* = אני – X, (2', 33'); the speech formula
  *īpuš-ma pâšu izzakkar ana šuāši* = 30) :פתח את פיו, ואליו דיבר'; Gilgameš's Y פתח את פיו ואמר, אל דיבר: without
  *iqabbi*); *gana luqbīka* = בוא, אוֹמְרָה לך (31', = Theodicy 1); the contest verbs *šanānu* = התחרה, *maṣû* Št =
  ('27) השתווה; *ṣāltu* = ריב, *ṣâlu* = ('32 ,'28) רב; *ṭapālu* D = ('32–'31) הוציא דיבה.
- **Shade, rest, refuge:** *ṣillu ṭābu* = צל טוב [cognate twice; Hos 4:13]; *emēdu* (7') = נשען, not חסה
  (Jiménez's "seeks refuge" would import Judg 9:15's חָסוּ): a split by sense from the Poor Man's *emēdu* השית.
  *rabābu* Š "relax" = התרפה (נח ;'6–'5 is *nâḫu*'s, נרגע *pašāḫu*'s).
- **The cult:** *šuluḫḫu* = ('12) טקס רחיצת־הידיים; *upuntu* = 23) קמח־האופות', as *maṣḫatu* קמח־מַצָּחַתּוּ;
  מנחה not used); *ginû* = מנה קבועה (קרבן־התמיד ;'24 is *sattukku*'s, 10'); *ušurtu* (34') = מַעֲשְׂרוֹת? – see
  the open decision; *gagû* = הַגָּגוּ (38', transliterated).

- **Other words:** *lulīmu* = יַחְמוּר (Deut 14:5; אַיָּל reads "ram"); *ummānu* = 8) ההמון', the corpus word, here
  "army"); *anḫūtu* = עייפות; *ṭaḫādu* D = השפיע; *gamāru* D = גמר (שלם is gated); *balu* + suffix = זולת;
  *parāsu* = פרס [cognate, Isa 58:7]; *tiʾūtu* = מזון; *ḫišiḫtu* = מצרכים; *šiāḫu* = גבה; *ṣimittu* = צמד [cognate]; *malallû* = דוברה; *išpartu* = אורגת; *qû* "thread" = חוט (by sense; the cognate קַו noted); *aru*
  (palm frond) = כפה (Lev 23:40); *šušāru* = פתיל; *eblu* = חבל [cognate]; *pasuttu* = רשתית (a new net word:
  the nets stay one Hebrew per lemma, §11.8, §11.10); *usandû* = צייד־הציפורים; *ṭawû* = שזר; *itinnu* = בנאי;
  *gušūru* = קורה; *āriru* = טוחן; *ḫamāṭu* Š = החיש; *tarāṣu* D stat. = מתוח; *šurbû* = נעלה) מרומם is *ṣīru*'s); *nibītu* = כינוי; *šalṭiš* = כשליט [cognate]; *âru* = ניגש; *muṣṣālu* = מריב; *ḫuršānu* = הרים; *qû* (measure) = קַב; *ḫiāqu* = מזג; *markasu* = קשר; *baʾūlātu* = נתינים; *elēṣu* D = העליץ [cognate];
  *nabāṭu* Š = הבהיק; *tiqnu* = עדיים; *rēma rašû* = רחמים קנה (literal); *puqqu* = קשוב; *liʾbu* = קדחת (Deut 28:22; חום is *ummu*'s); *abāru* III = ('47 ,'41) חבק; *šibṭu* = מכה (מגפה avoided: נגף is *nakāpu*'s);
  *zabālu* D "linger" = השהה (by sense; G = סבל); *arāmu* = עטה (and *katāmu* = כיסה, PO c+37); *matāqu* D =
  המתיק [cognate]; *lallaru* = מיילל (מקונן would collide with *damāmu* קונן); *nubû* = נהי (Jer 9:17); *ṣarāpu* D = צרב; *nabû* D "wail" = יבב (קרא stays *nabû* G's); *ramû* = רפה; *kasû* = כפות; *šurruḫu* =
  גאה; *lullû* = מעודן; *lammu* = שָׁקַד; *adāru* = אָדַר (transliterated; צפצפה is *ṣarbatu*'s); *nīlu* = שוכב.

## Open decisions for the user

1. *ušurtu* (34'): eBL's lemma is "group of ten", Jiménez translates "the tithe"; drafted מַעֲשְׂרוֹת?
   [cognate, with
   ?]. Alternative: העשיריות (neutral). The tithe of wine (Deut 14:23, 26) makes it a strong parallel if right.
2. *arhānû* = דָּקָל collides with Sumerian *ĝišimmar* = דקל in other corpora (Gudea A xxvi 2, Lipit-Ištar 133'–135',
   EWO 241), while the wisdom corpus has *gišimmaru* = תָּמָר: a cross-corpus split for the next harmonization (if
   *ĝišimmar* moves to דקל, תמר is free for *arhānû*).
3. *karānu* = יין throughout (the contestant "Wine"), with the modern title "הדקל והגפן";
   alternative: גֶּפֶן for
   the contestant only (a split by sense).

4. 37' *irâš*: eBL lemmatizes *riāšu* "rejoice" (drafted `וגל ברינה`), Jiménez translates "asks for" (*erēšu*).
5. 42' "I bring back from the netherworld plague (and) Namtar": drafted with Jiménez's reading ("(מוכה)" added); MS
   UrkHel1 reads "I send back to the netherworld".

## Progress log

- 2026-10-31: drafted 1'–54' in four saved sections (1'–15', 16'–28', 29'–35', 36'–54'), source lines by `fill`.
- Pass (a) fidelity: brackets checked against the ATF (6' partial, 28' restored, 30' and 32' suffixes not bracketed, 50'
  22 ;(`ל[פנים]` ' the scribe's omitted *ina* marked `⟨ב⟩`; the eBL note on UrkHel3's variant moved from 24' to 34'
  (where it belongs); 29' the {giš} determinative noted.
- Pass (b) consistency: formulas and the Palm quotations (3'/51', 4'/52', 9'/52') checked; *arāmu* changed `כיסה` →
  ('44) `עטה` to keep `כיסה` for *katāmu* (PO c+37); `wisdom_tools.py lemma` / `harmonize_survey.py heb` on every new word.
- Pass (c) Hebrew: the generated `translation-PV.rtl.md` read aloud; 49' `בעת הלילה` → `באישון לילה` (no "dead of night"
  in *šāt mūši*); intro: Šamaš vocalized.
- `verify PV --strict`: 0 problems; `check_bible_quotes.py`: 0 (two mismatches fixed: Dan 1:20 `הָאַשָּׁפִים`, Gen 42:6
  `הַשַּׁלִּיט`). Four footnotes (7', 26', 34', 36').

## Parallels index (PV)

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3' | *šīhāku lāna* | גבוה אני בגוף | זֹאת קוֹמָתֵךְ דָּמְתָה לְתָמָר (שיר השירים ז:ח) | [equivalent] | The palm's stature; the Akkadian has *lānu* "body", not *gattu* "stature". |
| 5' | *ina šaplīya rēʾû u kaparru ušarbabū* | תחתיי – הרועה ונער־הרועה ... מתרפים | וְתַחַת פֹּארָתָיו יָלְדוּ כֹּל חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה; וּבְצִלּוֹ יֶשְׁבוּ כֹּל גּוֹיִם רַבִּים (יחזקאל לא:ו) | [equivalent] | The great tree sheltering men and beasts; in Ezekiel (and Dan 4:9) an image of empire. |
| 7' | *ina ṣillīya ṭābi* | בצלי הטוב | תַּחַת אַלּוֹן וְלִבְנָה וְאֵלָה כִּי טוֹב צִלָּהּ (הושע ד:יג) | [cognate] | *ṣillu* / צֵל and *ṭābu* / טוֹב: the same phrase, "good shade". |
| 7' | *ina ṣillīya ... immid lulimmu* | בצלי הטוב – נשען היחמור | בֹּאוּ חֲסוּ בְצִלִּי (שופטים ט:טו) | [divergence] | Jotham gives the shade-offer to the bramble that has none; here the palm boasts of real shade. Jiménez's "seeks refuge" would manufacture חסה: the verb is *emēdu* "lean". |
| 7' | *lulimmu* | היחמור | אַיָּל וּצְבִי וְיַחְמוּר (דברים יד:ה) | [equivalent] | The red deer. |
| 9' | *ana inbīya ṣayyahūti iriššā apâtu* | על תנובתי המענגת – גלים הרבים | הֶחֱדַלְתִּי אֶת מָתְקִי וְאֶת תְּנוּבָתִי הַטּוֹבָה (שופטים ט:יא) | [equivalent] | The fig's produce in Jotham's fable; *inbu* = תנובה. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10' | *uṭahhad paššūr ilī* | משפיע אני על שולחן האלים | הֶחֱדַלְתִּי אֶת דִּשְׁנִי אֲשֶׁר בִּי יְכַבְּדוּ אֱלֹהִים וַאֲנָשִׁים (שופטים ט:ט) | [equivalent] | The tree's gift to the gods; the palm feeds both gods (10') and men (9', 13'–15'). |
| 12' | *gimir šuluhhi* | כל טקס רחיצת־הידיים | וְרָחֲצוּ אַהֲרֹן וּבָנָיו מִמֶּנּוּ אֶת יְדֵיהֶם וְאֶת רַגְלֵיהֶם (שמות ל:יט) | [equivalent] | Hand-washing before the sacred; in Babylon with palm (and tamarisk) in the water. |
| 13' | *aparras teʾûta* | פורס אני מזון | הֲלוֹא פָרֹס לָרָעֵב לַחְמֶךָ (ישעיהו נח:ז) | [cognate] | *parāsu* / פרס "dole out food". |
| 14' | *kurunna napšat nišī* | סובא מובחר נפש – האנשים | וְיַיִן יְשַׂמַּח חַיִּים (קהלת י:יט) | [equivalent] | The drink as "life"; = Theodicy 32 (the same phrase). |
| 16' | *ana epinnīšu ubbala ṣimitta* | אל מחרשתו מביא את הצמד | לֹא תַחֲרֹשׁ בְּשׁוֹר וּבַחֲמֹר יַחְדָּו (דברים כב:י) | [equivalent] | *ṣimittu* ~ צֶמֶד [cognate]. |
| 19' | *arūʾa* | כפותיי | כַּפּוֹת תְּמָרִים (ויקרא כג:מ) | [equivalent] | Palm fronds; in Babylon raw material for rope. |
| 21' | *ana gišparrīšu iṭammi ebla* | לפחו שוזר חבל | טָמְנוּ גֵּאִים פַּח לִי וַחֲבָלִים פָּרְשׂוּ רֶשֶׁת לְיַד-מַעְגָּל (תהלים קמ:ו) | [cognate] | *eblu* / חֶבֶל beside *gišparru* = פַּח [equivalent]; also הַתִּפֹּל צְפוֹר עַל פַּח הָאָרֶץ (עמוס ג:ה). |
| 24' | *ana paššūr ilī u šarri* | אל שולחן האלים והמלך | הַמְשַׂמֵּחַ אֱלֹהִים וַאֲנָשִׁים (שופטים ט:יג) | [divergence] | Jotham's "gods and men" against the Babylonian "gods and king". |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 25' | *turruṣā dalātūʾa* | מתוחות דלתותיי | וּשְׁתֵּי דַּלְתוֹת עֲצֵי שֶׁמֶן וְקָלַע עֲלֵיהֶם מְקֻלָּעוֹת כְּרוּבִים וְתִמֹרֹת (מלכים א ו:לב) | [divergence] | Solomon's temple doors carry carved palms; here the doors are palm wood. |
| 26' | *šurbâkū-ma eli kal iṣṣī nibīt šumīya šarra* | מרומם אני על כל העצים: כינוי שמי – מלך''י! | הָלוֹךְ הָלְכוּ הָעֵצִים לִמְשֹׁחַ עֲלֵיהֶם מֶלֶךְ (שופטים ט:ח) | [divergence] | **Key:** the trees and kingship. In Jotham's fable the useful trees refuse kingship because of their gifts; here the palm claims it because of them. |
| 26' | *eli kal iṣṣī … šarra* | על כל העצים … מלך | הַחוֹחַ אֲשֶׁר בַּלְּבָנוֹן שָׁלַח אֶל הָאֶרֶז אֲשֶׁר בַּלְּבָנוֹן (מלכים ב יד:ט) | [equivalent] | The plant fable of rank (Jehoash). |
| 28' | *šalṭiš* | כשליט | וְיוֹסֵף הוּא הַשַּׁלִּיט עַל הָאָרֶץ (בראשית מב:ו) | [cognate] | *šalāṭu* / שלט. |
| 29' | *karānu* | יַיִן | וַיֹּאמְרוּ הָעֵצִים לַגָּפֶן (שופטים ט:יב) | [divergence] | *karānu* is vine and wine at once; Jotham's fable separates תִּירוֹשׁ / גֶּפֶן. |
| 31' | *muṭappilu* | מוציא־דיבה | וּמוֹצֵא דִבָּה הוּא כְסִיל (משלי י:יח) | [equivalent] | *ṭapālu* / *ṭapiltu* = דִּבָּה (corpus §3). |
| 33' | *šikar hursanni* | שֵׁכָר ההרים | תְּנוּ-שֵׁכָר לְאוֹבֵד; וְיַיִן לְמָרֵי נָפֶשׁ (משלי לא:ו) | [cognate] | *šikaru* / שֵׁכָר; wine and beer as a pair. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 34' | *ušhāq ušrāti* | מוזג אני את המַעַשְׂרוֹת? | מַעְשַׂר דְּגָנְךָ תִּירֹשְׁךָ וְיִצְהָרֶךָ (דברים יד:כג) | [cognate] | Conditional: *ušurtu* (eBL "group of ten"; Jiménez "tithe") from *ešer* "ten"; the tithe of wine eaten "before YHWH" (Deut 14:23, 26). Also וְלַמַּעֲשְׂרוֹת (נחמיה יב:מד). Rests on Jiménez's reading. |
| 36' | *ullaṣ kabattašu ušnabbaṭ zīmīšu* | מעליץ אני את כבדו, מבהיק את זיוו | וְיַיִן יְשַׂמַּח לְבַב-אֱנוֹשׁ (תהלים קד:טו) | [equivalent] | **Key:** the same pair – the heart (Akk. liver) and the face (Ps 104:15b לְהַצְהִיל פָּנִים מִשָּׁמֶן) – said of a god here. |
| 36' | *ullaṣ* | מעליץ | עָלַץ לִבִּי בַּיהוָה (שמואל א ב:א) | [cognate] | *elēṣu* / עלץ. |
| 36' | *ullaṣ kabattašu* (of Šamaš) | מעליץ אני את כבדו | הַמְשַׂמֵּחַ אֱלֹהִים וַאֲנָשִׁים (שופטים ט:יג) | [equivalent] | Wine gladdens the god too. |
| 38' | *irašši rēma* | רחמים קונה | — | [cognate] | *rēmu* / רַחֲמִים (corpus §2). |
| 41' | *liʾbu* | קדחת | יַכְּכָה יְהוָה בַּשַּׁחֶפֶת וּבַקַּדַּחַת (דברים כח:כב) | [equivalent] | Fever. |
| 45' | *ina erši namtarīšu agammil napšassu* | על ערש נמתרו – חומל אני על נפשו | תְּנוּ-שֵׁכָר לְאוֹבֵד; וְיַיִן לְמָרֵי נָפֶשׁ (משלי לא:ו) | [divergence] | In Proverbs wine makes the dying forget (יִשְׁתֶּה וְיִשְׁכַּח רִישׁוֹ, משלי לא:ז); here it brings them back from death. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 45' | *ina erši* | על ערש | יְהוָה יִסְעָדֶנּוּ עַל-עֶרֶשׂ דְּוָי (תהלים מא:ד) | [cognate] | *eršu* / עֶרֶשׂ. |
| 44' | *ana qabri* | אל הקבר | — | [cognate] | *qabru* / קֶבֶר. |
| 46' | *umattaq lallara … nubûšu* | ממתיק אני את המיילל … נהיו | וְקִרְאוּ לַמְקוֹנְנוֹת וּתְבוֹאֶינָה (ירמיהו ט:טז) | [equivalent] | Professional mourners and their wailing (וְתִשָּׁנָה עָלֵינוּ נֶהִי, ירמיהו ט:יז); *matāqu* / מתק [cognate] (Judg 9:11 מָתְקִי). |
| 50' | *illak ina pān ṣābī* | הולך בפני הצבא | אֲשֶׁר יֵצֵא לִפְנֵיהֶם וַאֲשֶׁר יָבֹא לִפְנֵיהֶם (במדבר כז:יז) | [equivalent] | The leader; *ṣābu* / צָבָא [cognate]. |
| 53' | *lammu* | השָׁקֵד | מַקֵּל שָׁקֵד אָנִי רֹאֶה (ירמיהו א:יא) | [equivalent] | The almond; also Aaron's rod (וַיִּגְמֹל שְׁקֵדִים, במדבר יז:כג). |
| 53' | *ina rēš rāṭi* | בראש הרהט | בָּרְהָטִים בִּשְׁקָתוֹת הַמָּיִם (בראשית ל:לח) | [cognate] | *rāṭu* / רַהַט. |

## The text on its own terms

- **Utility as a claim to rank** (5'–26'): the palm lists what it gives the shepherd, the cattle, the deer, the army,
  mankind, the gods' table, the exorcist, the land (like the grain), and eight crafts – farmer, boatwright, weaver,
  fisherman, fowler, builder, priest, miller – and concludes "my title is 'king'" (26'). The Babylonian economy of the
  south seen from its one tree.

- **The palm in the cult** (10'–12', 23'–24'): dates on the gods' table, palm parts in the exorcist's rites and in the
  hand-washing (*ŠU.LUḪ*), palm heart whitening the priest's flour, the regular portions to "the table of gods and king"
  (the king eats the gods' leftovers).
- **Wine from the mountains** (33'): "the beer of the mountains" – an imported luxury in Babylonia, the drink of temples
  and kings, against the local date-beer.
- **The gods drink** (34'–38'): wine poured "at the gods' table" gladdens Šamaš's liver and lights his face; he dresses in
  his finery, rejoices in song and "acquires mercy" – the god's mood, and so his mercy, depends on the offering.
- **Wine as medicine and consolation** (41'–48'): it heals fever, brings the dying back from the netherworld, "sweetens"
  the professional mourner – hyperbole in the style of the gods' "who gives life to the dead".
- **Dream omens** (49'–50'): whoever sees wine at night will lead the army – the language of the dream books.
- **Debating technique**: insults first (31'), then counter-claims point by point (14'/39' over the same *kurunnu*;
  3'–9'/51'–52' the opponent's boasts quoted and twisted: "tall" becomes "proud"), then a parable (53'–54': the small
  almond at the head of the channel beats the big tree lying in it).
- **A late text**: copied in Hellenistic Uruk, among the last cuneiform literature; the scribe's *ḫepi eššu* ("new
  break", 34') shows he copied an already damaged tablet.

## Lines shared with other files

- 14' = Theodicy 32 (*kurunnu napšat nišī*): סובא מובחר – נפש האנשים – copied.
- 31' = Theodicy 1 (*gana luqbīka*): בוא, אוֹמְרָה לך copied.
- 13' cf. Atra-ḫasīs OB II 9 (eBL link; not translated in this corpus).

## Proposals for the shared renderings

- Contestants as names without the article; *arhānû* דְּקָל, *karānu* יַיִן (the contestant), *gišimmaru* תָּמָר.
- אני – X, (*anākū-ma X*); פתח את פיו, ואליו דיבר: (*īpuš-ma pâšu izzakkar ana šuāši*); *gana luqbīka* בוא, אוֹמְרָה לך.
- *šanānu* התחרה, *šitnuntu* התחרות (PO), *maṣû* Št השתווה; *ṣâlu* רב, *muṣṣālu* מריב; *ṭapālu* D הוציא דיבה.

- *emēdu* "lean" נשען (split by sense from השית); *rabābu* Š התרפה; *lulīmu* יַחְמוּר; *ušurtu* מַעַשְׂרוֹת?;
  *šuluḫḫu* רחיצת־הידיים; *upuntu* קמח־האופוּנְתוּ; *ginû* מנה קבועה; *gagû* הַגָּגוּ.
- *liʾbu* קדחת; *lallaru* מיילל; *nubû* נהי; *abāru* III חבק; *arāmu* עטה / *katāmu* כיסה; *zabālu* D השהה.
- *pasuttu* רשתית (nets); *eblu* חבל; *šušāru* פתיל; *aru* כפה; *lammu* שָׂקֵד; *adāru* אֲדָרוּ.

## Lessons for the guidelines

- An eBL note can sit under the wrong line in a reading (the UrkHel3 variant note belongs to 34', not 24'): read the ATF
  of each manuscript before attributing a variant.
- eBL's lemma and Jiménez's translation disagree in several places (37' *riāšu* / "asks for"; 54' *bâʾu* II "come" /
  "surpasses"; PO a+6 *nahāsu* / "weeps"; PO d+23 *marru* "bitter" / "shovel"): in this edition check both against the
  signs before choosing.

# PO

## Scope

The Series of the Poplar (*iškar ṣarbati*; eBL L/2/8, ed. and tr. E. Jiménez), all 82 labels in four fragments
(a+1–a+7, b+1–b+9, c+1–c+41, d+1–d+25), whose order is not certain. Manuscripts: one Late Babylonian library tablet from
Babylon in three pieces (BabLB1a–c) and two Neo-Assyrian tablets from Nineveh (NinNA1a+b, NinNA2). File
annotated-PO.rtl.md; intro translation--intro-PO.rtl.md.

## Sources consulted

As PV (../../sources/eBL/Fable-Poplar/); Etana (../../אגדות-מלכים/) for *ṣarbatu*; the cross-corpus survey.

## Decisions

- **Contestants:** *ṣarbatu* = צַפְצָפָה (Etana; Ezek 17:5), feminine as in Akkadian; *martû* = מַרְתּוּ (transliterated, always vocalized: Jiménez's "Ash" is uncertain, and מרתו reads "his mistress"). Other uncertain
  trees transliterated (*šaššūgu* שַׁשּׁוּגוּ, *adāru* אֲדָרוּ in PV); certain ones by name (אֶשֶׁל, תָּמָר, אֹרֶז, שׁוּרְבִּין, רִמּוֹן).

- **Speech formulas:** *X pâšu īpuš-ma ana Y amāta izakkar* = דבר Y פתח(ה) את פיו (פיה), ואל X דיבר(ה): (c+6, d+14:
  PV 30' + the Poor Man's *amāta zakāru* דבר דיבר); *X ana Y amāta izzakkar* = דבר דיבר Y אל X: (c+32, = PM 27).
  *aggiš* = בקצף (*agāgu* = קצף, corpus §5).
- **Words:** *alālu* Gt = התהלל [cognate] (a+4); *qīšu* = חורש; *apu* = אגם; *ṣulūlu* = סכך (c+16; not חסה / מחסה); *ḫaṭṭu* = מקל (a beating stick; שבט stays *šabbiṭu*'s); *lā māgiru* = מי שאינו מתרצה (*magāru* = רצה); *naṭû* = הכה; *qarādu* D = אימץ; *akû* (I and II) = תשוש (חלש is *enšu*'s); *lutû* = זרד;
  *eṭēru* = חילץ / *šūzubu* = הציל; *mangālu* = מַנְגָּלוּ (transliterated, meaning unknown); *birtu* = בירה
  [cognate]; *nanṣabu* = מרזב; *kilīlu* = זר; *zaʾānu* D = עיטר; *šukuttu* = תכשיטים (*šukānu* תכשיט in Ludlul:
  recorded); *iṣṣūr šāri* = ציפור־הרוח; *maštaku* = חדר; *zabālu* = סבל [cognate]; *makkūru* = נכסים; *būšu* =
  רכוש; *nukurtu* = איבה; *rukūbu* = רְכוּב [cognate, Ps 104:3]; *sarāqu serqa* = זרה זרייה; *gišḫurru* = צורה; *mīlu gapšu* = גאות הגואה; *māḫiru* = יריב; *tâmtu gallatu* = הים המתגלגל; *ḫamṭūtu* = בחופזה; *bušṭītu* = תולעת־העץ; *marāqu* = שחק; *palāšu* D = נקב; *riksu* = פרק; *tarahhu* = מדרון; *ḫerû* = חפר; *māḫiṣu* (PAN.TAG.GA) = קַשָּׁת; *nurmû* = רִמּוֹן; *ṣabātu* stat. "captive" = אסור (by sense); *puḫur*
  *kullati* = אספת הכלל (עולם reserved); *muḫalliq* = מאבד; *kaqdâ* = תמיד; *šarû* (of shade) = רב; *šamāḫu* =
  שגשג; *larû* = ענף; *šitnuntu* = התחרות; *marāṣu* Š = הֶחֱלָה (Isa 53:10); *šīr ilūti* = בשר אֱלוּת; *sapānu*
  = שיטח; *tallu* = מוט (קורה is *gušūru*'s); *masāku* Š stat. = נמאס; *rakāsu* = אגד (קשר is *kaṣāru*'s); *kankannu* = כַּן; *dannu* = חזק; *marru* "spade" = מָרָא [cognate, Mishnaic/Aramaic]; *šerʾu* = תלם.

## Open decisions for the user

1. *martû* transliterated (Jiménez "Ash" = מֵילָה); *šaššūgu* too ("Elm" = בּוּקִיצָה).
2. c+15 *ilīšu* (DINGIR-MEŠ-*šu*$_2$): drafted plural אֱלָיו; Jiménez singular "his god".
3. d+23: eBL lemmatizes {giš}MAR as *marru* I "bitter" – a slip; read *marru* "spade" = מָרָא.
4. d+21 *kankannu* כַּן and Exod 30:18 וְכַנּוֹ: tagged [equivalent]; a cognate (*kannu* / כֵּן) is possible but
   unchecked.
5. c+20 *šukuttu* תכשיטים beside Ludlul's *šukānu* תכשיט (two lemmas, one Hebrew root).

## Progress log

- 2026-10-31: drafted a+1–d+25 in six saved sections (a+1–a+4, a+5–c+8, c+9–c+22, c+23–c+41, d+1–d+13, d+14–d+25).
- Pass (a) fidelity: brackets against the ATF – c+23 לפני and c+38 חפור unbracketed (root preserved), c+31 נכסי[ל],
  d+17 תנובתך and d+23 תלמו (only the suffix broken); d+10 Jiménez's "you are plucked" removed from the line (not in
  N); d+7 העולם (reserved) → הכלל.
- Pass (b) consistency: the formulas of c+6 / d+14 / c+32 against PV 30' and PM 27; *katāmu* כיסה / *arāmu* עטה;
  gender (the poplar speaks in the feminine: c+13 מאמצת).
- Pass (c) Hebrew: c+20 כזר → כבזר; d+22 spacing.
- `verify PO --strict`: 0 problems; `check_bible_quotes.py`: 0. Four footnotes (a+3, c+11, c+12, d+17).

## Parallels index (PO)

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| a+2 | *ina qīši* | בחורש | וְחֹרֶשׁ מֵצַל (יחזקאל לא:ג) | [equivalent] | The shading thicket of Ezekiel's cedar parable. |
| a+3 | *ṣarbatu* | צַפְצָפָה | קָח עַל מַיִם רַבִּים צַפְצָפָה שָׁמוֹ (יחזקאל יז:ה) | [equivalent] | The Bible's only צַפְצָפָה, in the eagle-and-vine fable (Etana's precedent). |
| a+4 | *ītallal ṣarbatu* | התהללה צפצפה | אַל יִתְהַלֵּל חֹגֵר כְּמְפַתֵּחַ (מלכים א כ:יא) | [cognate] | *alālu* Gt / הִתְהַלֵּל: the same stem and sense; also אַל יִתְהַלֵּל עָשִׁיר בְּעָשְׁרוֹ (ירמיהו ט:כב). |
| c+8 | *ereqqu* | העגלה | עֹשֶׂה-עָשׁ כְּסִיל וְכִימָה (איוב ט:ט) | [equivalent] | Ursa Major ("the Wagon"); עָשׁ is so understood by many commentators. |
| c+10 | *tamkāru* | התגר | — | [cognate] | *tamkāru* / תַּגָּר (a loanword). |
| c+11 | *ul issekkerū mê nagbi* | לא ייסכרו מי המעמקים | וַיִּסָּכְרוּ מַעְיְנֹת תְּהוֹם (בראשית ח:ב) | [cognate] | **Key:** *sekēru* N / נִסְכַּר with the waters of the deep (*nagbu* / מעמקים תְּהוֹם): the end of the flood in Genesis; field irrigation here. |
| c+12 | *ina haṭṭīya … inattû zumuršu* | במקלי … מכים את גוו | שׁוֹט לַסּוּס מֶתֶג לַחֲמוֹר; וְשֵׁבֶט לְגֵו כְּסִילִים (משלי כו:ג) | [equivalent] | **Key:** the stick on the body (*zumru* = גו) and the fool (*lillu* = כסיל, c+13); also וְשֵׁבֶט לְגֵו חֹשְׂכֵי חֲסַר-לֵב (משלי י:יג), שְׁבָטוֹ שׂוֹנֵא בְנוֹ (משלי יג:כד). *ḫaṭṭu* is not שבט (*šabbiṭu*'s). |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| c+13 | *uqarrad lilla* | מאמצת אני את הכסיל | אִוֶּלֶת קְשׁוּרָה בְלֶב-נָעַר; שֵׁבֶט מוּסָר יַרְחִיקֶנָּה מִמֶּנּוּ (משלי כב:טו) | [equivalent] | Education by the stick. |
| c+14 | *upattâ uznīšu* | אפתח את אוזניו | אֲדֹנָי יְהוִה פָּתַח לִי אׇזֶן (ישעיהו נ:ה) | [equivalent] | Opening the ear; וַיְגַל אׇזְנָם לַמּוּסָר (איוב לו:י): through suffering, there; through the stick, here. |
| c+15 | *usallam ilīšu* | משלים עם אֵלָיו | וְאִם לֹא תַשְׁלִים עִמָּךְ (דברים כ:יב) | [cognate] | *salāmu* / הִשְׁלִים. |
| c+16 | *eli kabti u muškēni šakin ṣulūlu* | על הנכבד ועל המסכן – שׂוּם סכך | עָשִׁיר וָרָשׁ נִפְגָּשׁוּ; עֹשֵׂה כֻלָּם יְהוָה (משלי כב:ב) | [equivalent] | Rich and poor together; *muškēnu* / מִסְכֵּן [cognate] (וּמָצָא בָהּ אִישׁ מִסְכֵּן חָכָם, קהלת ט:טו). |
| c+16 | *ṣulūlu* | סכך | וְסֻכָּה תִּהְיֶה לְצֵל יוֹמָם מֵחֹרֶב (ישעיהו ד:ו) | [equivalent] | Shelter as shade. |
| c+16 | *ṣulūlu* (of the poplar) | סכך | תַּחַת אַלּוֹן וְלִבְנָה וְאֵלָה כִּי טוֹב צִלָּהּ (הושע ד:יג) | [divergence] | לִבְנָה (a poplar?) is praised for its shade; *ṣarbatu* is the Euphrates poplar, and the Hebrew does not write לבנה. |
| c+18 | *inaṣṣarū birta* | נוצרים את הבירה | וַאֲנִי הָיִיתִי בְּשׁוּשַׁן הַבִּירָה (נחמיה א:א) | [cognate] | *birtu* / בִּירָה (a late loan); *naṣāru* / נָצַר [cognate]. |
| c+22 | *izabbila makkūra* | סובל את נכסיו | וַיֵּט שִׁכְמוֹ לִסְבֹּל (בראשית מט:טו) | [cognate] | *zabālu* / סָבַל "carry". |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| c+24 | *rukūbu* | הָרְכוּב | הַשָּׂם-עָבִים רְכוּבוֹ (תהלים קד:ג) | [cognate] | The gods' processional vehicle (a boat) / God's "vehicle" of clouds. |
| c+29 | *uballaṭ lā lēʾâ ušezzeb enša* | מחיה אני את מי שאינו מסוגל, מצילה את החלש | כִּי הָיִיתָ מָעוֹז לַדָּל מָעוֹז לָאֶבְיוֹן בַּצַּר לוֹ מַחְסֶה מִזֶּרֶם צֵל מֵחֹרֶב (ישעיהו כה:ד) | [equivalent] | Rescuing the weak from the flood – a god's work in Isaiah, a boat's here. |
| c+34 | *ana marāqi* | לשחוק | וְשָׁחַקְתָּ מִמֶּנָּה הָדֵק (שמות ל:לו) | [equivalent] | Grinding fine. |
| c+39 | *uš[ebber?]* | יע[ביר?] | — | [cognate] | *ebēru* / עבר (restored). |
| d+2 | *nurmû* | הִרְמוֹן | אֶרֶץ חִטָּה וּשְׂעֹרָה וְגֶפֶן וּתְאֵנָה וְרִמּוֹן (דברים ח:ח) | [equivalent] | A list of trees. |
| d+3 | *erēnu* | הארז | הַחוֹמֵ אֲשֶׁר בַּלְּבָנוֹן שָׁלַח אֶל הָאֶרֶז אֲשֶׁר בַּלְּבָנוֹן (מלכים ב יד:ט) | [cognate] | *erēnu* / אֶרֶז. |
| d+11 | *šuršūka ul dunnunū* | שורשיך אינם חזקים | וְעַל יוּבַל יְשַׁלַּח שָׁרָשָׁיו (ירמיהו יז:ח) | [cognate] | *šuršu* / שֹׁרֶשׁ; and the uprooted vine הֲלוֹא אֶת שָׁרָשֶׁיהָ יְנַתֵּק (יחזקאל יז:ט). |
| d+12 | *ul šaru ṣillaka* | לא רב צלך | בֹּאוּ חֲסוּ בְּצִלִּי (שופטים ט:טו) | [divergence] | A tree mocked for its scant shade; Jotham's bramble offers the shade it does not have. *ṣillu* / צֵל [cognate]. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| d+15 | *ušamris[su]* | הֶחֱלָה [אותה?] | וַיהוָה חָפֵץ דַּכְּאוֹ הֶחֱלִי (ישעיהו נג:י) | [equivalent] | *marāṣu* Š "make sick, vex" / הֶחֱלָה; a different root (Hebrew נִמְרָצָת is the cognate, corpus §3). |
| d+16 | *kīma bīni … ul šīr ilūti* | כְּאֵשֶׁל – … לא בשר אֱלוּת | וּשְׁאֵרִיתוֹ לְאֵל עָשָׂה לְפִסְלוֹ (ישעיהו מד:יז) | [divergence] | **Key:** the tree that becomes a god's body – mocked by the prophets (also כִּי עֵץ מִיַּעַר כְּרָתוֹ מַעֲשֵׂה יְדֵי חָרָשׁ בַּמַּעֲצָד, ירמיהו י:ג), the highest honour here. |
| d+17 | *gišimmari šar iṣṣī* | תָּמָר, מלך העצים | הָלוֹךְ הָלְכוּ הָעֵצִים לִמְשֹׁחַ עֲלֵיהֶם מֶלֶךְ (שופטים ט:ח) | [equivalent] | **Key:** "king of trees" as the palm's standing title (cf. PV 26'); Jotham's king is the bramble, Jehoash's tree the cedar. |
| d+17 | *inib[ka ul innakkal?]* | תנובתך [לא תיאכל?] | הֶחֱדַלְתִּי אֶת מָתְקִי וְאֶת תְּנוּבָתִי הַטּוֹבָה (שופטים ט:יא) | [divergence] | The tree's produce as its merit (the fig in Jotham's fable). |
| d+21 | *[kanka]nnūk?* | [כַּנ]ך? | וְעָשִׂיתָ כִּיּוֹר נְחֹשֶׁת וְכַנּוֹ נְחֹשֶׁת לְרָחְצָה (שמות ל:יח) | [equivalent] | The stand of a washing vessel (restored word); perhaps cognate (*kannu*). |
| d+23 | *ina marri* | בַּמָּרָא | — | [cognate] | *marru* "spade" > Aramaic / Mishnaic מָרָא (eBL's lemma "bitter" is a slip). |
| d+23 | *šerʾāšu* | תלמו | תְּלָמֶיהָ רַוֵּה (תהלים סה:יא) | [equivalent] | The furrow (Sum. *absin*$_3$ = תֶּלֶם, creation corpus). |

## The text on its own terms

- **The ancient title** *iškar ṣarbati* "the Series of the Poplar": the scribes catalogued the debates like any other
  literary series; one copy from Ashurbanipal's library, one from Late Babylonian Babylon.
- **A tree's whole economy** (c+9–c+31): the merchant, the irrigation dam, the school and court stick, the cult, the city
  gate, the roof drain, the palace, the wind vane, river boats, the king's barge, the gods' processional boat, rescue in
  the spring flood, the sea, the booty of war – Mesopotamian life is made of poplar wood.
- **Discipline by the stick** (c+12–c+14): the poplar "makes the fool brave" and "opens the ears" of the deaf – the
  Babylonian school (the *é-dub-ba*'s "man in charge of the whip") as much as the Proverbs.
- **Cult and magic** (c+15, c+25–c+27): poplar twigs to reconcile a man (or the king) with his gods; a woman's scattered
  offering and the gesture of stroking the nose; the magic circle (*gišḫurru*) in which god and king stand – the
  purification of statues and of kings.
- **Wood for gods' bodies** (d+16): the tamarisk is "divine flesh" – the statue's core, made god by the mouth-washing
  ritual; the poplar is not.
- **A carpenters' debate** (c+33–c+39): hard wood (*martû*) holds the soft poplar's joints, makes the spades and arrows;
  soft wood makes boats and doors. The debate turns technical knowledge into rhetoric.
- **Insult and the verdict-less fragment**: "stupid of trees" (d+9), "despicable" (d+19), "furiously" (d+14); a god
  (Nudimmud = Ea, b+4) is named, perhaps the judge, but the end is lost.

## Lines shared with other files

- c+6, d+14 (speech formula): PV 30' + PM 27 (*amāta zakāru* דבר דיבר); c+32 = PM 27's pattern.
- d+19 *gana luqbīka* = PV 31', Theodicy 1.
- c+16 ≈ d+22 (*eli X u Y šakin* …): the same Hebrew frame שׂוּם … – Y וְ־ X עַל.

## Proposals for the shared renderings

- *ṣarbatu* צַפְצָפָה (feminine contestant); *martû* מַרְתּוּ ★ (always vocalized); *šaššūgu* שַׁשּׁוּגוּ.
- Formulas: דבר דיבר Y אל X:; פתח(ה) את פיו (פיה), ואל X דבר דיבר(ה) Y:; *aggiš* בקצף.

- *alālu* Gt התהלל; *ṣulūlu* סכך; *ḫaṭṭu* (stick) מקל; *lā māgiru* מי שאינו מתרצה; *qarādu* D אימץ; *akû* תשוש; *lutû* זרד; *birtu* בירה; *nanṣabu* מרזב; *rukūbu* רְכוּב; *mīlu gapšu* גאות הגואה; *māḫiru* יריב; *šitnuntu* התחרות; *marāṣu* Š הֶחֱלָה; *šīr ilūti* בשר אֵלוּת; *tallu* מוט; *rakāsu* אגד; *kankannu* כַּן; *marru* (spade) מָרָא; *šerʾu* תלם; *katāmu* כיסה; *makkūru* נכסים, *būšu* רכוש.

### Lessons for the guidelines

- In a fragmentary composite whose fragments' order is unknown, the section headings should name the fragment letters
  (a, b, c, d) so the reader sees that the order is the editor's; the intro says so.

## OH

### Scope

The Series of Ox and Horse (eBL `L/2/9`, ed. and tr. E. Jiménez), all 217 labels in nine fragments (1, A+1–A+38,
D+1–D+15, E+1–E+10, A+1'–A+32', B+0–B+38, B+1'–B+37', C+1–C+18, F+1–F+21, G+1–G+6); Nineveh library tablets only
(NinNA1a–c, NinNA2–5; Lambert's A–G). Opening: Ištar (restored from the catch-line), Enlil hearing prayers, the spring
flood (A+9–A+20), Ox and Horse's friendship turning into a quarrel (A+21–A+23), then alternating speeches; the end and
any verdict are lost. Files `annotated-OH.rtl.md`, `translation--intro-OH.rtl.md`, generated `translation-OH.rtl.md`.

### Sources consulted

eBL edition, ATF, glossary, notes (`../../sources/eBL/Fable-Ox-and-Horse/`); Jiménez's English after each draft line;
the corpus renderings, PV/PO, Gilgameš (VI 53 for the horse's epithet), the cross-corpus survey for every new word.

### Decisions

- **Contestants:** *alpu* = שׁוֹר (the cognate אֲלָפִים in the apparatus, A+21), *sisû* = סוּס [cognate]; names
  without the article.

- **The two speech formulas** (fixed, each ~9 copies, identical by verify):
  Ox – שור פתח את פיו ואמר, אל סוס, הנאדר בקרב, דיבר: (Gilgameš's דיבר Y פתח את פיו ואמר, אל X: + the horse's
  epithet copied from Gilgameš VI 53 הסוס, הנאדר בקרב; *naʾdu* is נזהר in the Theodicy – a recorded split);
  Horse – סוס פתח את פיו ואמר, אל שור המושלם דבר דיבר: (Nergal and Ereškigal's pattern; *gitmālu* = מושלם).
- **War words** one each: *tāḫāzu* מלחמה, *qablu* קרב (Gilgameš; *qerbu* "inside" is vocalized קִרְבָּה at A+19),
  *tuqumtu* תגרה.
- **The flood scene** (A+9–A+20 = A+27–A+32 in the Ox's mouth, copied line for line): *mīlu* גאות, *gapāšu* גאה,
  *nagbu* המעמקים, *ṣuṣû* סבך־קנים, *tabālu* סילק (Š הסיע), *wabālu* הוביל, *qerbetu* כרים, *bamātu* במות
  [cognate], *makāru* הרווה, *tamertu* נאות, *ugāru* שדמה, *ḫarru* אפיק, *natbāku* זרם, *raḫāṣu* שטף, *šaddûʾa* **סחף ההרים**, *mēreštu* מזרע, *ruṭibtu* רטיבות [cognate], *ḫarbu* חרבה [cognate]. **No *abūbu***: no
  מבול.
- **Other words:** *rūʾūta epēšu* עשה עמיתות; *ṣālūtu* מריבה; *ulṣu* עליצות; *rîtu* מרעית; *rēš šatti* ראש השנה [cognate]; *erēšu* חרש; *rāḫ kīdi* מפרה הבר; *darāsu* דרס [cognate]; *nakāru* D נִכֵּר; *šimtu* (brand)
  תו; *lāsimu* רץ; *ēnu* אֱנוּ; *padānu* משעול (Gilgameš; SH's *sulû* משעול – recorded); *kadāru* התנשא;
  *gīdu* גיד [cognate] (beside §3's *šerʾānu* גיד: one logogram SA, recorded); *katappû* רסן; *appātu* מושכות;
  *balāṣu* נעוץ (Ludlul II 73); *ašṭu* קשה; *ḫarḫarru* שרשרת; *rubṣu* גללים (Ludlul II 106); *agālu* עֲיִר; *tupšikku* סל; *nādu* נאד [cognate]; *tayyāru* חנינה; *urû* אורווה [cognate]; *agurru* לבנים שרופות; *kabāsu* דרך; *šarāḫu* D מהודר; *qadāšu* D קידש [cognate]; *šalālu* שלל [cognate]; *karāṣu*/*kerṣu* קרץ/קריצה (Ludlul V 80); *igru* שכר; *mersu* מָרְסוּ; *ešertu* מעונות?; *emēdu* stat. עמוס (a third sense-split of *emēdu*).

## Open decisions for the user

1. The horse's epithet: Gilgameš's הנאדר בקרב (copied) vs the wisdom corpus's *naʾdu* = נזהר (Theodicy).
2. *alpu* = שור (natural) vs the cognate אֶלֶף (poetic, Ps 8:8, Prov 14:4) – drafted שור.
3. *qablu* קרב beside *qerbu* קרב in one file (homographs; DP had avoided קרב for war).
4. *gīdātu* (Held) גיד vs Lambert's *šerʾānu*, which the corpus also renders גיד.
5. *bamātu* במות [cognate] in its topographic sense – a reader may hear the cult "high places".

## Progress log

- 2026-10-31: drafted all 217 labels in nine saved sections (1–A+17, A+18–A+26, A+27–A+38, D+1–D+8, D+9–E+10,
  A+1'–A+32', B+0–B+38, B+1'–B+37', C/F/G).
- Pass (a) fidelity: brackets by the partial-restoration rule – about 30 lines unbracketed or narrowed where the root is
  preserved (A+9, A+10, A+13, A+14, A+16, A+33, A+35, D+3, D+4, D+13, E+3, E+5, A+13', A+16', A+18', A+27'–A+29', C+11–C+16,
  F+5, F+10, B+25'–B+28'); D+14 `[אתה]`; C+7 an added object removed.
- Pass (b) consistency: the 18 formula lines and the flood repeats (A+15 = A+29, A+16 = A+31) identical by `verify`;
  `natbāku` moved `זרם` → `שטף` to free `שטף` for *raḫāṣu*.
- Pass (c) Hebrew: A+4' `כשמלה` → `כבשמלה`; A+2' `[תוור]ו`; F heading.
- `verify OH --strict`: 0 problems; `check_bible_quotes.py`: 0 (one fixed: Qoh 1:15 `לְתִקֹּן`). Seven footnotes.

## Parallels index (OH)

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A+10 | *pura[tti]* | פְּרָת | וְהַנָּהָר הָרְבִיעִי הוּא פְּרָת (בראשית ב:יד) | [cognate] | The river names. |
| A+11 | *idi]glat* | החִדֶּקֶל | וְשֵׁם הַנָּהָר הַשְּׁלִישִׁי חִדֶּקֶל (בראשית ב:יד) | [cognate] | Eden's rivers as the source of plenty. |
| A+12 | *igdapšū mê nagbi ul īšû pāna u bāba* | גאו מי המעמקים, אין להם פנים ושער | נִבְקְעוּ כָּל מַעְיְנוֹת תְּהוֹם רַבָּה (בראשית ז:יא) | [divergence] | **Key:** the waters of the deep "beyond measure" – a curse in Genesis, the yearly blessing here; the scene is *mīlu* (spring flood), not *abūbu*. Restored word. |
| A+14 | *bamāti* | הבמות | וְדַרְךְ עַל בָּמֳתֵי אָרֶץ (עמוס ד:יג) | [cognate] | *bamātu* "open slopes" / בָּמוֹת in its topographic sense. |
| A+14 | *tamerāti* | הנאות | בִּנְאוֹת דֶּשֶׁא יַרְבִּיצֵנִי (תהלים כג:ב) | [equivalent] | Pasture lands. |
| A+13 | *qarbāti* | הכרים | יִרְעָה מִקְנֶיךָ בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא כַּר נִרְחָב (ישעיהו ל:כג) | [equivalent] | Pasture after the rains. |
| A+17 | *ana ruṭibti ittūrū* | לרטיבות נהפכו | מִזֶּרֶם הָרִים יִרְטָבוּ (איוב כד:ח) | [cognate] | *ruṭibtu* / רטב, from mountain torrents. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A+17 | *ašrāt lā mērešti … ana ruṭibti ittūrū* | מקומות שאין בהם מזרע – לרטיבות נהפכו | יְשָׂשׂוּם מִדְבָּר וְצִיָּה; וְתָגֵל עֲרָבָה וְתִפְרַח כַּחֲבַצָּלֶת (ישעיהו לה:א) | [equivalent] | The waste turned fertile. |
| A+18 | *išīhū šammū* | גבהו העשבים | מַצְמִיחַ חָצִיר לַבְּהֵמָה (תהלים קד:יד) | [equivalent] | Grass for the beasts. |
| A+21 | *alpu u sisû* | שׁוֹר וסוּס | צֹנָה וַאֲלָפִים כֻּלָּם (תהלים ח:ח) | [cognate] | *alpu* / אֶלֶף (poetic "cattle"); *sisû* / סוּס. Also בְּאֵין אֲלָפִים אֵבוּס בָּר (משלי יד:ד). |
| A+21 | *alpu* | שור | יָדַע שׁוֹר קֹנֵהוּ וַחֲמוֹר אֵבוּס בְּעָלָיו (ישעיהו א:ג) | [equivalent] | The faithful working ox. |
| A+23 | *ippuša ṣālūta* | ועשו מריבה | אַל נָא תְהִי מְרִיבָה בֵּינִי וּבֵינֶךָ וּבֵין רֹעַי וּבֵין רֹעֶיךָ (בראשית יג:ח) | [divergence] | Plenty breeds a quarrel (Abram and Lot's herds). |
| A+24 | *sisî naʾid qabli* | סוס, הנאדר בקרב | וּמֻרָחוֹק יָרִיחַ מִלְחָמָה (איוב לט:כה) | [equivalent] | The war-horse; the epithet = Gilgameš VI 53. |
| A+26 | *ina rēš šatti* | בראש השנה | בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה בָּעָשׂוֹר לַחֹדֶשׁ (יחזקאל מ:א) | [cognate] | The same phrase; the Babylonian year begins in spring (Nisan). |
| A+34 | *idakkukū būrūnī* | מדלגים עגלינו | וַיִּרְקְדוּ כְּמוֹ-עֵגֶל (תהלים כט:ו) | [equivalent] | Gambolling calves. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A+35 | *idarrisa* | דורס | — | [cognate] | *darāsu* / דרס (post-biblical Hebrew). |
| A+2' | *šimtī* | תוי | וְהִתְוִיתָ תָּו עַל מִצְחוֹת הָאֲנָשִׁים (יחזקאל ט:ד) | [equivalent] | The owner's brand. |
| A+4' | *kīma ṣubāti nalbušāku* | כשמלה לבוש אני | הֲתַלְבִּישׁ צַוָּארוֹ רַעְמָה (איוב לט:יט) | [equivalent] | The war-horse "clothed" (mane / bronze armour). |
| A+5' | *mār lāsimi* | בן־הרץ | וַיֹּאמֶר הַמֶּלֶךְ לָרָצִים הַנִּצָּבִים עָלָיו (שמואל א כב:יז) | [equivalent] | The king's runners. |
| A+6' | *šarru … rubû ul iba’’ū padāna* | מלך … ונשיא לא יצעדו – במשעול | רַק לֹא יַרְבֶּה לּוֹ סוּסִים (דברים יז:טז) | [divergence] | **Key:** the horse as the emblem of rule in Babylon; the Torah limits the king's horses. |
| A+10' | *kal narkabti* | כל המרכבה | וַיִּבְטַח עַל רָכָב כִּי רָב (ישעיהו לא:א) | [divergence] | The chariot as the army's trust; here the ox claims it is made of him. |
| A+11'–A+12' | *ina maškīya … ina gīdātīya* | בעורותיי … בגידיי | עוֹר וּבָשָׂר תַּלְבִּישֵׁנִי; וּבַעֲצָמוֹת וְגִידִים תְּשֹׂכְכֵנִי (איוב י:יא) | [cognate] | *gīdu* / גִּיד; skin and sinews as building material (of a body / a chariot). |
| A+13' | *išpat[a]* | האשפה | עָלָיו תִּרְנָה אַשְׁפָּה (איוב לט:כג) | [cognate] | The quiver on the war-horse. |
| A+14' | *arīrī* | כידונים | לַהַב חֲנִית וְכִידוֹן (איוב לט:כג) | [equivalent] | Weapons of the chariot. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| A+15' | *katappū* | רסני | בְּמֶתֶג-וָרֶסֶן עָדְיוֹ לִבְלוֹם (תהלים לב:ט) | [equivalent] | **Key:** the horse ruled by the bridle, "without understanding" (A+16'–A+18'). |
| A+17' | *balṣā-ma īnāka* | נעוצות – עיניך | — | — | = Ludlul II 73 (restoration; Hebrew copied). |
| A+27' | *ašṭātā-ma alap* | קשה אתה, שור | כִּי עַם קְשֵׁה עֹרֶף הוּא (שמות לד:ט) | [equivalent] | The stubborn beast. |
| A+29' | *qaqqaru rubuṣka* | הקרקע – גלליך | — | — | = Ludlul II 106 בגלליי לנתי כשור (restored word). |
| B+9 | *dimtašu kīma mê nādi* | דמעתו כמי הנאד | שִׁימָה דִמְעָתִי בְנֹאדֶךָ (תהלים נו:ט) | [cognate] | *nādu* / נאד with *dimtu* / דִּמְעָה: tears and waterskin together. |
| B+11 | *attā u agālu tazabbilā tupšikka* | אתה והעֵיר – תסבלו סלים | הַסִירוֹתִי מִסֶּבֶל שִׁכְמוֹ; כַּפָּיו מִדּוּד תַּעֲבֹרְנָה (תהלים פא:ז) | [cognate] | *zabālu* / סבל and the labour basket; ox and ass as the working pair (לֹא תַחֲרֹשׁ בְּשׁוֹר וּבַחֲמֹר יַחְדָּו, דברים כב:י). |
| C+4 | *nissaba hitbuṣat išebbi* | ניסבה נתפחה, תשבע | וְרֵב-תְּבוּאוֹת בְּכֹחַ שׁוֹר (משלי יד:ד) | [equivalent] | **Key:** the ox's whole argument in one proverb. |
| C+6 | *quddušat ana ilī* | מקודשת לאלים | — | [cognate] | *qadāšu* / קִדֵּשׁ. |
| C+11 | *nadi urû'a* | מוצבת אורוותי | וַיְהִי לִשְׁלֹמֹה אַרְבָּעִים אֶלֶף אֲרֻוֹת סוּסִים לְמֶרְכָּבוֹ (מלכים א ה:ו) | [cognate] | *urû* / אֲרֻוָה: the royal horse stalls. |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| C+13 | *utaqqanū* | מתקנים | מְעָוָּת לֹא יוּכַל לְתָקֵן (קהלת א:טו) | [cognate] | *taqānu* / תקן. |
| C+16 | *[ul inn]akkal šīrī* | לא ייאכל בשרי | כֹּל מַפְרֶסֶת פַּרְסָה וְשֹׁסַעַת שֶׁסַע פְּרָסֹת מַעֲלַת גֵּרָה בַּבְּהֵמָה אֹתָהּ תֹּאכֵלוּ (ויקרא יא:ג) | [divergence] | Horse flesh not eaten: unclean in the Torah, too noble here. |
| E+3 | *iṭṭira napšassu* | יחלץ את נפשו | שָׁקֶר הַסּוּס לִתְשׁוּעָה; וּבְרֹב חֵילוֹ לֹא יְמַלֵּט (תהלים לג:יז) | [divergence] | The horse saves its rider (claim) / "a vain hope for victory" (psalm). Also לֹא בִגְבוּרַת הַסּוּס יֶחְפָּץ (תהלים קמז:י). |
| B+28' | *ikruṣu keressun* | קרצו את קריצתן | מֻחֹמָר קֹרַצְתִּי גַּם-אָנִי (איוב לג:ו) | [cognate] | *karāṣu* / קרץ: creation from pinched clay (= Ludlul V 80). |
| F+19 | *ašallal* | אשלול | — | [cognate] | *šalālu* / שָׁלַל. |
| F+10 | *ellā šullumā* | טהורים, שלמים | — | [equivalent] | Unblemished offerings (the Bible's תְּמִים, reserved here). |

## The text on its own terms

- **The spring flood as blessing** (A+9–A+20, A+27–A+32): springs, Euphrates and Tigris, snow-melt torrents, reed
  thickets swept away, wasteland turned moist – the agricultural year of Babylonia; "the head of the year" is spring.
- **Satiety breeds quarrel** (A+21–A+23): friends grown fat on pasture "rejoice" and start a dispute – the genre framed
  as sport.

- **Field against chariot**: the ox is "son of the meadow" (A+35), plough and "fertiliser of the steppe" (A+32), source
  of grain consecrated to the gods (C+4–C+6); the horse is the king's: courier, governor, priest and prince ride it
  (A+5'–A+6'), its stable stands before the king, attendants choose its greens, it treads baked bricks (C+10–C+14).
- **Materials of war**: the ox's hide and sinews make the chariot, the reins, the quiver (A+10'–A+15') – Assyrian
  technology argued from below.
- **Insults of rank**: the ox eats bran and lies in dung, chained, carries panniers with the donkey, is "a house-born
  slave" (A+27'–A+29', B+7, B+11); the horse is "untrustworthy", "strange-looking", blinkered (A+16'–A+18', B+14–B+15).
- **Food taboos as status**: the horse's flesh "is not eaten" (C+16).
- **Prayer language** in the ox's mouth ("let me bless", "decree my welfare", B+25'–B+26') and creation language in
  the horse's ("pinched off the clay", "unnamed", "names", B+28'–B+30').
- **King and prince** appear near the end (F+2), perhaps as judges, as Enlil in the Sumerian contests.

## Lines shared with other files

- The two speech formulas (18 lines), identical throughout; the Ox formula = Gilgameš's pattern with Gilgameš VI 53's
  epithet; the Horse formula = Nergal and Ereškigal's pattern.
- A+15 = A+29, A+16 = A+31 (identical); A+12/A+27, A+13/A+28, A+14/A+30, A+17/A+32 (cf., the shared words identical).
- A+17' ← Ludlul II 73; A+29' ~ Ludlul II 106; B+28' ← Ludlul V 80 (Hebrew copied).

## Proposals for the shared renderings

- Formulas: שור פתח את פיו ואמר, אל סוס, הנאדר בקרב, דיבר: / סוס פתח את פיו ואמר, אל שור המושלם דבר דיבר:.
- *alpu* שׁוֹר, *sisû* סוּס; *tāḫāzu* מלחמה, *qablu* קרב, *tuqumtu* תגרה; *urû* אורווה; *nādu* נאד; *gīdu* גיד; *katappû* רסן, *appātu* מושכות; *bamātu* במות; *qerbetu* כרים; *tamertu* נאות; *ṣuṣû* סבך־קנים; *natbāku* זרם, *raḫāṣu* שטף; *ḫarbu* חרבה; *ruṭibtu* רטיבות; *darāsu* דרס; *agālu* עֲיִר; *tupšikku* סל; *šalālu* שלל; *qadāšu* D קידש; *taqānu* D תקן; *šimtu* (brand) תו.

### Lessons for the guidelines

- A brief's "the series opens with a flood" must be checked against the lemma: the flood here is *mīlu*, the yearly
  spring flood, not *abūbu*; rendering it מבול would have manufactured a Gen 6–9 echo.
- A recurring speech formula restored in most copies should be fixed with its bracket placement rule (Hebrew order ≠
  Akkadian order: a broken *izzakkar* goes to the end of the Hebrew line in brackets).

## SP

### Scope

The Series of the Spider (eBL L/2/11, ed. and tr. E. Jiménez), all 59 labels (1–34, 42–65, 107); NinNA1 (Nineveh,
1–14) and AššNA1 (Aššur, the main witness). A creation prologue (1–6), the Spider's boast (7–8), Ninšiku (Ea) creating
two small creatures, *ḫamānīru* and *ešqapīzu*, naming them (9–12), their "battle" and *ešqapīzu*'s mockery of the
Spider (13–23), the Spider's rebuke (24–34), *ḫamānīru*'s answer (42–54); the rest fragments.

### Sources consulted

eBL edition, ATF, glossary; Jiménez's English; Enūma eliš I 1 (*enūma* כאשר), Erra (*šiknat napišti*, *nabnītu*),
Etana (*nammaštû*, *būl ṣēri*), the Theodicy 265 (*šibqu*), the creation corpus (*uṣurtu*, *bašāmu*).

### Decisions

- *ettūtu* = עַכָּבִישׁ (gated); *ḫamānīru* חַמָּנִירוּ, *ešqapīzu* אֶשְׁקַפִּיזוּ (transliterated, always vocalized); Ninšiku נִינְשִׁיכּוּ; Utaʾūlu אוּתָאוּלוּ.
- Creation verbs as the creation corpus: *banû* בנה, *bašāmu* תכן, *wapû* Š הופיע, *eṣēru* צר (cognate יצר in
  the apparatus), *uṣurtu* צורה; *burūmû* רום־השמים (never רקיע); *kiūru* קִיאוּר.
- Beings: *šiknat napišti* בעלי הנפש, *nammaštû* נעים, *būl ṣēri* בהמת השדה, *umām ṣēri* חית השדה, *būl Šakkan*
  בהמת שַׁכַּן, *nabnītu* תולדה.
- *nabû* קָרָא (licensed: naming), *nibītu* כינוי, *zikru* זכר; *šarāḫu* D/Š הידר, Dt/Št התהדר; *ṣuḫāru* קטנטן; *ganūnu* מדור; *kiṣṣu* קודש; *zubbu* זבוב; *laʾātu* בלע; *šuparruru* פרש; *pīru* פיל; *ṭarādu* הבריח (not טרד); *seḫû* סער; *dāriš* לעד; *muttaggišu* משוטט; *tabnītu* בנין; *kubukku* און.

## Open decisions for the user

1. *kiūru* restored by eBL (`[?קיאור]`) – transliterated.
2. 9 *attalad* "I (hereby) bore" – the performative perfect rendered `ילדתי`.
3. 61: eBL's T has "weapon" from the ATF (*kakku*), the normalization has "..." – the Hebrew follows N.

## Progress log

- 2026-10-31: drafted 1–107 in one saved file; `verify` caught `הנה?` (reserved) in 9 – removed.
- Passes: (a) brackets narrowed in 6, 7, 10, 11, 12, 32–34, 45, 63; 26 `תי[עצ]`; (b) the lists 4 / 28 identical;
  *nabû* `קראתי` licensed; (c) 25 `משלי` (reads "Proverbs") → `שלי`.
- `verify SP --strict` 0; `check_bible_quotes.py` 0; two footnotes.

## Parallels index (SP)

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | *šiknat napišti* | בעלי הנפש | וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר יִקְרָא לוֹ הָאָדָם נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה הוּא שְׁמוֹ (בראשית ב:יט) | [equivalent] | "Forms of life" / נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה; the Hebrew avoids both נפש חיה and רמש. |
| 4 | *būl ṣēri umām ṣēri* | בהמת השדה, חית השדה | וַיִּצֶר יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים מִן הָאֲדָמָה כָּל חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה וְאֵת כָּל עוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם (בראשית ב:יט) | [equivalent] | **Key:** "beasts of the field" created, then named (10–12). |
| 7 | *ettūtu uštarraḫ* | עכביש התהדר | וּבֵית עַכָּבִישׁ מִבְטַחוֹ (איוב ח:יד) | [divergence] | The spider as futile trust (Job, Isa 59:5) / the spider boasting of strength. |
| 10 | *[a]ttabi šumēšun* | קראתי את שמותם | וַיִּקְרָא הָאָדָם שֵׁמוֹת לְכָל הַבְּהֵמָה וּלְעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם וּלְכֹל חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה (בראשית ב:כ) | [cognate] | **Key:** *nabû* / קָרָא of naming the creatures; the god names them here, the man in Genesis. |
| 12 | *zikiršu* | זכרו | זֶה שְׁמִי לְעֹלָם וְזֶה זִכְרִי לְדֹר דֹּר (שמות ג:טו) | [cognate] | *zikru* "name" / זֵכֶר. |
| 19 | *bēl arni lā ʾiṭ zumbī* | בעל עוון, בולע זבובים | בְּבַעַל זְבוּב אֱלֹהֵי עֶקְרוֹן (מלכים ב א:ב) | [divergence] | Jiménez's "master of flies" manufactures Baal-zebub; *bēl* goes with *arni*. *zubbu* / זְבוּב [cognate]. |
| 19 | *zumbī* | זבובים | זְבוּבֵי מָוֶת יַבְאִישׁ יַבִּיעַ שָׁמֶן רוֹקֵחַ (קהלת י:א) | [cognate] | |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 20 | *ušparraru eṭla* | פורש על העלם | קוּרֵיהֶם לֹא יִהְיוּ לְבָגֶד (ישעיהו נט:ו) | [equivalent] | The web spread at night; Isaiah's webs that cover nothing. Also וְקוּרֵי עַכָּבִישׁ יְאָרֹגוּ (ישעיהו נט:ה). |
| 21 | *pīra* | הפיל | — | [cognate] | *pīru* / פִּיל (post-biblical). |
| 22 | *īrurūšu bān ilī* | ארוהו בונה האלים | אָרוּר אַתָּה מִכָּל הַבְּהֵמָה וּמִכֹּל חַיַּת הַשָּׂדֶה (בראשית ג:יד) | [divergence] | A small creature cursed by a god, "as its name" says. |
| 31 | *uṣṣirū ana dāriš* | צרו לעד | וַיִּצֶר יְהוָה אֱלֹהִים מִן הָאֲדָמָה (בראשית ב:יט) | [cognate] | *eṣēru* / יצר – root only: "design, fix the pattern" (rendered צר). |

## The text on its own terms

- A **creation prologue** for a quarrel (1–6): the assembly of gods builds the world, brings forth living beings and
  gives every kind its dwelling and its shrine – even insects belong to the sacred order.
- **Ea answers boasting by creation** (9–12): the god "bears" two tiny rivals and names them ironically ("the mighty").
- The **"designs of the great gods"** that Anu, Enlil and Ea fixed forever (30–31): quarrel among creatures disturbs
  cosmic order; the boaster turns peacemaker (24–33) – a wisdom twist.
- The **spider seen by its enemies** (19–22): fly-swallower, spreading its web over the sleeper at night, cursed.
- **Debate as lawsuit** (48: "you stand in his case"), creatures with shrines and great meals (52–53).

## Lines shared with other files

- 26 cf. Theodicy 265 (למד את תחבולותיי); 28 ≈ 4 (the lists of creatures, identical Hebrew).

### Proposals for the shared renderings

- *ettūtu* עכביש; *nammaštû* נעים; *umām ṣēri* חית השדה; *šiknat napišti* בעלי הנפש; *burūmû* רום־השמים;
  *eṣēru* צר; *zikru* (name) זכר; *šarāḫu* Dt/Št התהדר; *zubbu* זבוב; *pīru* פיל; *ṭarādu* הבריח.

### Lessons for the guidelines

- A rank-3 phrase can build a famous echo out of a construct chain that belongs elsewhere (19 "master of flies"): parse
  every *bēl* + noun before tagging.

## WR

### Scope

The Story of the Poor, Forlorn Wren (eBL L/2/13, ed. and tr. E. Jiménez), all 42 labels (1–27, 29–43); Late
Babylonian and Parthian library tablets from Babylon and school tablets from Babylon and Nippur. Eagle nests on the
mountain, Wren lays eggs on a low plant; Wren prays to Šamaš, the judge; Eagle is bound and brought down; Wren calls the
birds to praise Šamaš; the closing moral.

### Sources consulted

eBL edition, ATF, glossary; Jiménez's English; Etana (../../אגדות-מלכים/, *erû* נָשָׁר, *watmu* אפרוח, the eagle's
punishment); Gilgameš X 309 (*qinna qanānu*).

### Decisions

- *duqduqqu* = גִּדְרוֹן (the config title), *arû* = נָשָׁר, both as names without the article; the epithet *akû*
  *lapnu* = התשוש והדל (38 ,12 ,5 ,3: *akû* as in PO/OH, *lapnu* corpus §3).
- *qinna qanānu* קינן קן; *watmu* אפרוח (גוזל reserved); *pelû* ביצה; *nīnû* נִינוּ (transliterated plant); *surdû* נֵץ; *mutellu* רם; *mugdašru* אדיר; *nukaribbu* גנן; *šisītu* צעקה; *palāḫu* (physical) פחד; *ṣummû* צמא; *dayyān kitti* דיין האמת (not "righteous"); *kamû* שבה; *kitta epēšu* עשה אמת; *tanitta dabābu*
  סיפר תהילה; *ṣabābu* הניף (not פרש ,רחף); *masnaqtu* מבחן; *damqātu* חסדים; *qabû* "call" אמר 15):
  קרא reserved for *nabû*).

## Open decisions for the user

1. *duqduqqu* גדרון (identification uncertain).
2. 43 *damqātu* (adj. *damqu*, "good things") rendered חסדיו (the *damiqtu* noun's word) rather than נאותיו.
3. 38 the verb is restored (*uštamḫiranni?*), [השווה?].

## Progress log

- 2026-10-31: drafted 1–43 in two saved parts; 15 קוראים (reserved קרא) → 32 ;אומרים an added [מן] removed.
- Passes: (a) brackets narrowed in 6, 12, 22, 32; (b) the epithet identical in 3, 5, 12, 38; (c) read aloud.
- verify WR --strict 0; check_bible_quotes.py 0 (one fixed: a bare "לב:יא" read as Genesis); two footnotes.

## Parallels index (WR)

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | *arû ina šadî iqtanan qinna* | נשר בהר קינן קן | אִם-עַל-פִּיךָ יַגְבִּיהַ נָּשֶׁר; וְכִי יָרִים קִנּוֹ (איוב לט:כז) | [equivalent] | *qinna qanānu* / קִנָּן קֵן [cognate]. |
| 2 | *iltakna pelâšu* | שֹׂם את ביציו | כִּי יִקָּרֶא קֵן צִפּוֹר לְפָנֶיךָ בַּדֶּרֶךְ בְּכָל עֵץ אוֹ עַל הָאָרֶץ אֶפְרֹחִים אוֹ בֵיצִים (דברים כב:ו) | [equivalent] | The small bird's exposed nest. |
| 8 | *surdû* | הנץ | הֲמִבִּינָתְךָ יַאֲבָר-נֵץ (איוב לט:כו) | [equivalent] | Hawk and eagle together (Job 39:26–27). |
| 9 | *ana akāl šīrī* | לאכול את הבשר | מְשָׁם חָפַר-אֹכֶל (איוב לט:כט) | [equivalent] | The eagle's prey; וְאֶפְרֹחָו יְעַלְעוּ-דָם (איוב לט:ל). |
| 19 | *atmī arî* | אפרוחי נשר | כְּנָשֶׁר יָעִיר קִנּוֹ עַל גּוֹזָלָיו יְרַחֵף (דברים לב:יא) | [equivalent] | Eagle and young (אפרוח per Etana; גוזל reserved). |
| 23 | *šamaš dayyān ki[tti]* | שמש, דיין האמ[ת] | הַשֹּׁפֵט כָּל הָאָרֶץ לֹא יַעֲשֶׂה מִשְׁפָּט (בראשית יח:כה) | [equivalent] | The divine judge appealed to by the weak; Jiménez's "righteous" is *kittu* "truth". |
| 35 | *kitta epšā* | עשו אמת | וְעָשִׂיתָ עִמְּדִי חֶסֶד וֶאֱמֶת (בראשית מז:כט) | [equivalent] | "Doing truth" = loyalty. |
| 36 | *tanittašu dubbā* | ספרו את תהילתו | לְדֹר וָדֹר נְסַפֵּר תְּהִלָּתֶךָ (תהלים עט:יג) | [equivalent] | The thanksgiving vocabulary. |
| 38 | *duqduqqa akâ lapna itti arî danni* | גדרון התשוש והדל, עם הנשר החזק | מֵקִים מֵעָפָר דָּל מֵאַשְׁפֹּת יָרִים אֶבְיוֹן (שמואל א ב:ח) | [equivalent] | The god raising the poor (*lapnu* = דל). |

| Line | Akkadian | Hebrew rendering | Bible | Tag | Comment |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 39 | *lā iqabbi arû mā šaqi šadû* | אל יאמר נשר: 'רם ההר!' | אִם תַּגְבִּיהַ כַּנָּשֶׁר וְאִם בֵּין כּוֹכָבִים שִׂים קִנֶּךָ מִשָּׁם אוֹרִידֶךָּ (עובדיה א:ד) | [equivalent] | **Key:** the proud eagle's high nest and its fall (also כִּי תַגְבִּיהַ כַּנָּשֶׁר קִנֶּךָ מִשָּׁם אוֹרִידֶךָּ, ירמיהו מט:טז). |
| 40 | *šapil nīnû* | שפל הנינו | וְרָמֵי הַקּוֹמָה גְּדוּעִים וְהַגְּבֹהִים יִשְׁפָּלוּ (ישעיהו י:לג) | [cognate] | *šapālu* / שָׁפֵל; high and low reversed. |
| 41 | *ša bēl ittīšu qinna iqannan* | מי שבל עמו – קן יקנן | אִם-יְהוָה לֹא-יִבְנֶה בַּיִת (תהלים קכז:א) | [equivalent] | **Key:** the closing proverb – a home only with the god; also גַּם-צִפּוֹר מָצְאָה בַיִת וּדְרוֹר קֵן לָהּ (תהלים פד:ד). |
| 42 | *iṣappap kappī urabba bukuršu* | יניף כנפיים, יגדל את בכורו | יִפְרֹשׂ כְּנָפָיו יִקָּחֵהוּ יִשָּׂאֵהוּ עַל אֶבְרָתוֹ (דברים לב:יא) | [equivalent] | Wings that raise the young. |

## The text on its own terms

- A **school text** with a moral (copied by pupils in Babylon and Nippur): the small trust the god, the great fall.
- **Prayer of the persecuted** (4–26): the bird spreads its wings like hands, names itself by its misery ("the one-shekel bird", "small is my stature"), describes hunger, thirst and fear, and appeals to Šamaš, "judge of truth".
- **Divine reversal and thanksgiving** (29–38): the eagle bound and brought down; the rescued bird calls all birds to "make truth" (alliance) and praise the god – a thanksgiving psalm in miniature.
- **Etana's eagle punished again**: the same crime (eating a neighbour's young) and the same punishment (wings).
- **The moral** (39–43): neither pride nor complaint – "he whom Bēl is with builds a nest".

## Lines shared with other files

- 1 *qinna qanānu* = Gilgameš's קנן קן; Etana's eagle words copied (*erû*, *watmu*, *kappu*).

## Proposals for the shared renderings

- *duqduqqu* גִּדְרוֹן; *akû lapnu* התשוש והדל; *pelû* ביצה; *surdû* נֶץ; *nukaribbu* גנן; *dayyān kitti* דיין האמת; *kitta epēšu* עשה אמת; *ṣabābu* הניף; *masnaqtu* מבחן; *nīnû* נִינוּ.

## Lessons for the guidelines

- A gate on קרא catches the ordinary "they call me" (*qabû*): write אומרים לי; and a bare reference such as "לב:יא"
  is read as Genesis by the quote checker – always write the book.